



T20s for the win

However, T20s continued to be the gateway drug for cricket, with a record 654 contests being played in 2024 — the most in any calendar year, in addition to the relentless cacophony of global franchise leagues. Underdog New Zealand's victorious Women's T20 World Cup campaign in the UAE also added gloss to the format's penchant for

unpredictability.

Meanwhile, one-day cricket's status as an orphaned child only grew more acute as just 104 international matches were played in the format, the least since 1994. After the 2023 World Cup, not too many teams wanted to go through the rigours of the 50-over format, with only four of the top eight teams featuring in the top 12 list of teams

All smiles: Temba Bavuma-led South Africa became the first team to reach the final when it beat Pakistan in the Boxing Day Test in Centurion. GETTY IMAGES

that played the greatest number of ODIs in 2024.

India and New Zealand, with three games apiece, were placed at the bottom of the 20-team list. Bilateral